



△ *Gustavus Adolphus at Breitenfeld*, Johann Walther, 1632

1631

SWEDISH VICTORY AT BREITENFELD

Under King Gustavus Adolphus, Sweden became a major European military power. In 1630, Gustavus joined in the Thirty Years' War on the Protestant side, leading his army to support Saxony against the Catholic Holy Roman Empire. At the battle of Breitenfeld, the Swedes and Saxons triumphed over the Imperial forces thanks to the Swedish king's superior generalship. Gustav Adolphus was killed in battle the following year.

1630

1631 In the Sack of Magdeburg, in the Thirty Years' War, 20,000 Protestants are massacred by Catholic troops

1633 Italian astronomer Galileo Galilei is condemned by the Inquisition for his heliocentric views

1630 The American colony of Massachusetts is settled by Puritans fleeing persecution in Stuart England

1632 Swedish king Gustavus Adolphus is killed when fighting at the Battle of Lützen

Around eight million civilians and soldiers died in the Thirty Years' War

1636

RISE OF THE MANCHU

In 1636, Hong Taiji, leader of the Manchu people, claimed the right to rule all of China as founder of a new dynasty, the Qing.

In reality, the Chinese empire was still ruled by the Ming dynasty in Beijing, but the growing military might of the Manchus gave substance to their ambitions. In the winter of 1636 they invaded Korea, forcing the country to acknowledge their overlordship. A Qing invasion of China was soon to follow.



△ Qing dynasty imperial helmet